



OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER

Welcome to Arike Day Care Nurses Bulletin! Within these pages, we unveil the significance of our endeavors, highlighting the positive impact they generate in our community. Your ongoing support propels our journey of empathy and empowerment. We couldn't do it without you. Thank you for being a part of our mission!

Addressing the Silent Crisis: Elderly Abuse

Elderly abuse, a distressing reality faced by many, transcends physical, emotional, and financial boundaries, leaving an indelible mark on the lives of the elderly. In this month's newsletter, we shed light on the often-hidden struggles faced by seniors and those responsible for their care.

"Every wrinkle tells a story, showing the chapters of a lifetime behind their frailty," reflects a palliative nurse, offering a glimpse into the profound lives of those who have weathered the storms of time. Our journey into the world of elderly abuse is one that demands our attention and compassion.

Look out for unexplained injuries, emotional withdrawal, sudden financial changes, poor hygiene, and neglectful living conditions of elderly around you.

Unveiling the Shadows of Elderly Abuse

Elder abuse — is a grave concern, encompassing physical, emotional, financial, sexual, and neglectful mistreatment of older adults.

The voices of those affected speak volumes:
"I have worked hard for my family, throughout my life. I thought my old age would be filled with tranquillity, not fear," whispers an elderly woman subject to emotional abuse.

"In the silence of my pain, I found strength to speak out," shares a courageous soul, breaking the shackles of silence surrounding abuse

The Role of Vigilance and Empathy

Much like dementia care, addressing elderly abuse requires patience and understanding. *"It's not just about physical bruises; emotional scars run deep,"* remarks a palliative medical professional, emphasising the importance of recognizing the subtle signs of abuse.

Promoting awareness within families is crucial to recognizing signs of abuse, emphasising the need for open communication with elderly relatives. Caregivers and volunteers play a pivotal role; comprehensive training on identifying abuse signs and proper care techniques is essential. Community programmes supporting caregivers, encouraging social activities for seniors, and public awareness campaigns contribute to a protective network. Empowering ourselves and our communities through knowledge ensures our elders age with dignity and respect.

"Knowing the signs and reporting abuse is our duty, a commitment to safeguarding the vulnerable," advocates a dedicated volunteer. Awareness can be a powerful tool in preventing and addressing the issue.

Resilience in the Face of Adversity

As we navigate the complexities of elderly abuse, stories of resilience emerge. *"No one should feel alone in the later years of life. It's our job to protect the elderly together,"* says a caregiver, emphasising the collective responsibility to protect the elderly.

Simple acts of kindness and vigilance can transform lives. *"In the small gestures lies the power to heal and protect,"* notes a family member whose loved one faced abuse, underscoring the significance of communal support.

Initiatives like Koode are currently envisioned to play a crucial role in reporting and combating elderly abuse. The ongoing strategy involves enlisting the support of local law enforcement for emergencies, empowering vigilant community volunteers to recognize and report signs of abuse, and collaborating with Local Government and Municipal (LSGI) members for a coordinated, community-wide awareness and response. This unified effort ensures a swift and effective frontline defence against elderly abuse.



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24/7
Emergency
Home Care

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Elderly abuse may cast a long shadow, but within it, we find the strength to advocate for change.

"We are the voice of the silent, the defenders of the vulnerable," declares a volunteer healthcare advocate, rallying us to stand united against this grave injustice.

As we delve into the shadows of elderly abuse, let us strive to become beacons of empathy, guardians of dignity, and champions of a world where the elderly are cherished, protected, and respected.

"In every elderly person, there is a universe of wisdom waiting to be explored. Let us be the explorers, not the exploiters."

Koode Stakeholders' Meeting

District Administration conducted a comprehensive session on "Koode" for Koode stakeholders on 12th October at the Ernakulam Collectorate, Kakkanad. The session was not only informative but also engaging, shedding light on the significance of the initiative. On behalf of Arike, Mr. Rony John Madathil and Geena Varghese participated in the meeting. The event served as a collaborative platform for stakeholders to gain a deeper understanding of "Koode" and its potential impact on the community.



Let's unwrap the magic of Christmas

Join us in bringing joy to patients this Christmas week with heartwarming carols at their homes.

Your presence and donations will make this programme a success, lighting up the festive season for those in need. Let's celebrate together!



World Hospice and Palliative Care Day observance

As part of the World Hospice and Palliative Care Day observance, Arike Palliative Home Care, in collaboration with St. Teresa's College, Ernakulam, organised a touching event for palliative care patients and their families on 14th October 2023. The programme received support from Key Value Enterprises, Max Caterings, Innerwheel Club of Cochin West, Snehasandwanam Club, IMA, Ast A, Bhumi and numerous generous individuals. This event aimed not only to bring solace to those in need but also to involve students, fostering a generation of empathy. The gathering included patients, caregivers, family members, and special school children from BUDS Special School, Mulavukad. The day was filled with joy, games, dance, and songs, providing a truly enjoyable and memorable experience. The event was graced by the presence of Dr. Junaid Rahman, former District Medical Officer, Dr. George Tukan, Secretary of IMA Cochin, Dr. Alphonsa, Principal of St. Teresa's College, Dr. Annie P. G, Dr. Geetha Vijayan, and other dignitaries.

Awareness Session

Dr. Geetha Vijayan and Mr. Rony John Madathil conducted an impactful awareness session on 'Koode' and palliative care for social work students at Rajagiri College of Social Sciences (Autonomous) on October 21, 2023. The class was well-received, providing valuable insights and fostering a meaningful understanding of the subject.

Arike Daycare Nurses have been delivering home-based palliative care for the past four years, aiding more than 1572 patients and their families. Despite our dedication, we face financial constraints in meeting the escalating demand for our services. Your support plays a pivotal role in expanding our reach and securing dignified lives for those in need. We sincerely urge you to consider contributing to ARIKE, helping us make a lasting impact in the lives of those requiring palliative care.

SUPPORT OUR CAUSE



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